MEWS Development Program

Risk & Issue Management — Portfolio Reference

This reference illustrates how project, product, quality, supplier, technical, and readiness risks could be structured and managed within a regulated medical-device development program. It is an anonymized portfolio reference, not a controlled project risk register.

1. Risk Management Approach

Risk management was treated as an ongoing delivery activity rather than a one-time planning exercise. Risks and blockers were identified through project work, stakeholder feedback, quality activities, technical discussions, supplier interactions, and readiness reviews. The project-management role was to maintain visibility, coordinate owners, assess impact, and follow mitigation or corrective actions through to closure.

2. Risk Management Flow

Identify	**Assess**	**Respond**	**Monitor**	**Close / Escalate**
Risk, blocker, dependency or emerging concern	Probability, impact, affected workstream	Avoid, reduce, contain, transfer or accept	Owner, action, due date, residual exposure	Evidence of closure or management decision

3. Portfolio Risk Register Sample

Risk Area	Potential Exposure	Response / Control	PM Focus
Requirements / Scope	Ambiguous or changing requirements can create rework, schedule pressure, or traceability gaps.	Clarify requirements, assess change impact, maintain traceability and review priorities.	Scope visibility, dependency tracking, stakeholder alignment.
Hardware / Firmware	Hardware, firmware, sensor, or integration dependencies can delay downstream verification.	Track engineering gates, integration dependencies, defects, and validation prerequisites.	Milestone tracking, escalation, cross-functional coordination.
Third-Party Technology	External technology or vendor dependencies can affect interoperability, delivery timing, or technical readiness.	Coordinate technical alignment, dependency reviews, integration testing, and issue escalation.	Vendor coordination and dependency management.
Component / Supplier	Component availability or supplier quality issues can affect production readiness.	Monitor supply dependencies, contain affected material where required, and use controlled change/corrective-action processes.	Supplier visibility, readiness decisions, action closure.
Quality / Compliance	Documentation, competency, audit, or QMS gaps can delay readiness or create nonconformities.	Track quality objectives, audit actions, corrective actions, documentation, and evidence.	Quality coordination, evidence readiness, escalation.
Production Readiness	Unresolved defects, process gaps, or readiness dependencies can delay pilot or mass production.	Assign owners and due dates; review inspection, testing, traceability, change control, and production criteria.	Go/no-go visibility and downstream dependency management.

4. Issue & Blocker Management

The project also distinguished active issues and blockers from future risks. A blocker or quality concern could be documented with its description and impact, then considered for inclusion in the formal risk management process. This supports a practical path from team-level problem identification to structured risk treatment and follow-up.

5. Risk, Quality & Regulatory Alignment

For a regulated medical-device program, risk management was connected with quality and lifecycle activities. The project operated within an ISO 13485 quality-management environment and supported ISO 14971 risk-management activities, while software lifecycle work was aligned with IEC 62304. Risk considerations therefore extended beyond schedule and cost to product safety, technical dependencies, verification and validation, documentation, supplier quality, and production readiness.

6. Project Manager Contribution

• Maintain visibility of project risks, issues, blockers, dependencies, and readiness gaps.

• Coordinate risk assessment and mitigation discussions with technical, quality, regulatory, manufacturing, and business stakeholders.

• Track owners, actions, target dates, dependencies, and escalation requirements.

• Assess the delivery impact of changes and emerging technical or operational issues.

• Keep unresolved quality and corrective-action items visible through closure.

• Escalate risks when exposure could affect milestones, validation, compliance, production, or project outcomes.

7. Evidence Boundary

This portfolio sample intentionally excludes controlled risk registers, patient information, proprietary hazard analyses, confidential supplier records, security credentials, proprietary algorithms, and other restricted project records.